

“TRANSITIONING FROM AN OPEN SOURCE MODEL TO CLOSED SOURCE DOESN'T WORK WELL”

The Document Foundation (TDF) is actively looking for volunteers in India who wish to contribute to this community. At *Open Source India* last October, **Lothar Karl Becker**, member and former chairman, The Document Foundation, spoke to *OSFY's Yashasvini Razdan* about the role of open source projects in creating cost savings for businesses.



Lothar Karl Becker, member and former chairman, The Document Foundation

Q What is the LibreOffice project and what role does The Document Foundation play in it?

A. The LibreOffice project follows a life cycle and plan for our software releases, issuing new versions of our office productivity software twice a year. Around these biannual releases, various tasks must be completed. Developments are integrated into the core software, and quality assurance is organised.

The Document Foundation (TDF) certifies its ecosystem partners for good services in training, migration,

and development while transitioning from another office productivity suite to LibreOffice. TDF staff and project volunteers collaborate on these tasks, requiring careful coordination. Each major version triggers diverse marketing activities, such as video production and information dissemination about new features. Additionally, new languages are translated for the user interface (UI) and help documentation. TDF orchestrates all LibreOffice-related tasks by handling contributions to the ongoing development and enhancement of the software.

Q How important is India for The Document Foundation?

We are increasingly ramping up our activities in India. We have observed a discrepancy in our community base, particularly between India's role in open source and its significant contribution to the community of TDF or the LibreOffice project. It is not just about TDF; it is about the LibreOffice project as a whole. Consequently, we have decided to concentrate some of our efforts on India, including marketing and awareness-raising activities, to expand our community base here, similar to what we have seen in other open source projects.